The Hook Vault

120 Song Hook & Title Ideas Across 6 Genres

How to use this vault

A hook is the part of the song people remember. This vault gives you 120 hook ideas, each with a **title**, an **angle** (the emotional spin), and a **first line** to get you writing in under a minute.

Three ways to use it

1. **Steal the angle, not the words.** Keep the emotional situation, change the details to your life.
2. **Flip it.** Take any hook and write the opposite (a breakup hook becomes a "we made it" hook).
3. **Stack two.** Combine the title from one with the angle from another.

Rule of thumb: a strong hook is short (2 to 7 words), sings easily on a repeated melody, and says one clear feeling.

Pop (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
1	Skipping the Part Where We Break Up	Wanting the happy ending without the pain	"Fast-forward past the crying"
2	Main Character Energy	Self-belief after a rough year	"Walked in like the movie's about me"
3	Seventeen Forever	Nostalgia for one summer	"Still got your jacket from that night"
4	Say It First	Courage to confess	"One of us has to break the quiet"
5	Glitter on the Floor	Morning after a party	"Everything shines when you're gone"
6	Not Your Plan B	Refusing to be second choice	"Ask me twice, I'm still not free"
7	Left on Read	Modern heartbreak	"Three little dots that never came"
8	Golden Hour Heart	Falling in love at sunset	"Light's so soft it hides my fear"

#	Title	Angle	First line
9	Kiss the Static	Chemistry that feels electric	“Every touch a radio wave”
10	Rent Free	Someone living in your head	“You never even paid for this”
11	Better Than Revenge	Growth as the best comeback	“I got louder by getting kind”
12	2 AM Philosopher	Late night overthinking	“Everything makes sense at two”
13	Call It Even	Settling a toxic score	“We keep the receipts, we keep the pain”
14	Pretty Little Panic	Anxiety dressed up fine	“Smiling with a racing heart”
15	Hometown Lights	Returning and feeling changed	“Same streets, different me”
16	Plus One	Going to the wedding alone	“Table for me and my ego”
17	Overdue	Finally taking a holiday from pain	“I’m cashing in my good days”
18	Heartbeat Delay	Love at long distance	“Your voice arrives a second late”
19	Bloom Where You Land	Resilience after moving	“Concrete cracks, I’m growing here”
20	Last Song on the Playlist	Closure	“This is where we fade out”

Hip-Hop / Rap (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
21	Receipts	Proof of the come-up	“Every doubt is in my ledger”
22	Hungry Hands	Work ethic	“Calluses are my signature”
23	Quiet Money	Staying low-key	“Loud ain’t the same as rich”
24	Block Philosopher	Wisdom from the corner	“Learned more here than in school”
25	Third Shift	Grinding while others sleep	“Moon’s my coworker now”
26	Mama’s Prayers	Gratitude, family	“Her knees wore out so I could stand”
27	Lowkey Legend	Underrated talent	“They’ll know when I’m gone”
28	Different Gravity	Feeling above the noise	“Bills pull down, dreams pull up”
29	Unpaid Intern of Life	Struggle humor	“Learning for free, still no check”
30	Chip on My Shoulder	Using doubt as fuel	“Weigh me down, I walk heavier”
31	Old Soul, New Flow	Blending eras	“Vinyl crackle, rapid-fire”
32	Cold Streets, Warm Heart	Contrast	“Ice outside, fire in my chest”
33	Ghost Writer	Being unseen but essential	“My words in other mouths”
34	Tax Bracket Blues	Money jokes with truth	“Level up, still get less”
35	Last Man Standing	Surviving the circle	“Count the empty chairs”

#	Title	Angle	First line
36	Rearview	Leaving the past	“Mirrors smaller than they seem”
37	Sunday Best	Pride and presentation	“Dressed for a war nobody sees”
38	Heavy Crown	Cost of success	“Gold weighs more than it looks”
39	Night Shift Poetry	Writing at work	“Receipts on the back of rhymes”
40	Proof of Life	Still here after it all	“Check my pulse, I’m still loud”

R&B / Soul (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
41	Slow Burn	Patient attraction	“No rush, let the candle melt”
42	Stay for Breakfast	Intimacy beyond the night	“Eggs and honey, don’t go yet”
43	Velvet Excuse	Making up reasons to call	“Said I lost my keys, I lied”
44	Soft Spot	Vulnerability	“Only you can find my weak spot”
45	Half Past Love	Late-in-life romance	“We found it after the show”
46	Whisper Rules	Secret relationship	“What we say stays in this room”
47	Candle Math	Counting the days apart	“Eleven wicks since you’ve been gone”
48	Honey in the Lines	Love letters	“Sweet on every word I write”
49	Come Home Slow	Reunion	“Take the long way back to me”
50	Moonlit Mistake	Regret with beauty	“Wrong, but it felt like silk”
51	Silk and Static	Mixed signals	“You’re smooth then you disappear”
52	Holding Space	Emotional support	“I got room for all your storms”
53	Almost Mine	Unrequited	“Almost’s a cruel word to sing”
54	Warm Side of the Bed	Missing someone	“Still leaving room for you”
55	Love Language	Learning each other	“You say it with your hands”
56	Perfume on the Pillow	Memory	“I washed it, but it stays”
57	Midnight Mercy	Asking for grace	“Be gentle with my heart tonight”
58	Sunday Slow	Lazy love	“Nowhere to be, no one but you”
59	Tender Is the Word	Redefining strength	“Strong enough to soften”
60	Proof in the Quiet	Silent love	“We don’t need to say a thing”

Country / Folk (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
61	Dust on the Dashboard	Small town memory	“Still got your name in the dirt”
62	Porch Light Prayer	Waiting for someone to come home	“Left it on for you again”
63	Back Forty	Land and legacy	“Daddy’s dirt is in my veins”
64	Mason Jar Moon	Rural romance	“Caught the light, put a lid on it”
65	Four Wheels and a Dream	Escape	“Gas tank full, heart still not”
66	Church Pew Confessions	Guilt and grace	“Told the preacher, then you”
67	Last Call Cowboy	Bar-closing heartbreak	“Lights come on, truth comes out”
68	Hand-Me-Down Hands	Inheriting traits	“I got her hands and his temper”
69	Gravel Roads Know	Secrets of home	“Every curve remembers us”
70	Sweet Tea Sunday	Family gatherings	“Grandma’s laughter in a glass”
71	One Stoplight Town	Staying or leaving	“Red light, green light, same old”
72	Boots by the Door	Domestic love	“Always know when you’re home”
73	Whiskey Wisdom	Lessons learned	“Cheaper than a therapist”
74	Rust and Roses	Beauty in age	“Time bloomed what it broke”
75	Kitchen Radio	Dancing at home	“Stirring soup and slow dancing”
76	Burn the Letters	Ending a chapter	“Smoke’s the only thing I send”
77	Wide Open Heart	Starting again	“Window down, past behind”
78	Barn Light Blues	Late-night loneliness	“One bulb and a lot of silence”
79	Tin Roof Rain	Comfort	“Storm sings me back to sleep”
80	Anchored in Amen	Faith in hard times	“Held on when the river rose”

Rock / Alternative (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
81	Gasoline Heart	Passion that burns out	“One spark and I’m all in”
82	Static in My Veins	Restlessness	“Radio won’t turn off”
83	Wreckage Parade	Celebrating survival	“Raise a flag for what’s left”
84	Louder Than Doubt	Self-belief	“Turn the amp until I believe”

#	Title	Angle	First line
85	Concrete Wings	Escaping a city	“Built to leave, never to land”
86	Glass Houses Burning	Truth coming out	“Everyone throws, nobody builds”
87	Neon Nowhere	Aimless youth	“Lit up and going nowhere”
88	Wake the Quiet	Breaking silence	“I’m tired of the polite hush”
89	Hollow Anthem	Empty success	“Sing along to nothing”
90	Rust Belt Romeo	Blue-collar romance	“Steel town, soft heart”
91	Sparks on the Highway	Freedom	“We scratch the night with chrome”
92	Riot in My Chest	Anxiety, anger	“Drums I can’t turn off”
93	Dead Weather	Dying relationship	“Cold front hanging in the room”
94	Pulse of the Parking Lot	Underground scene	“Best show was outside the gate”
95	Burn the Map	No plan, no fear	“Lost is the only route”
96	Collision Course	Inevitable love	“We knew it’d hurt, we came anyway”
97	Echo Chamber Kid	Isolation online	“Only hear what I say”
98	Ashes Look Good on Me	Rebirth	“Wear what’s left with pride”
99	Saints and Speakers	Music as religion	“Worship in a basement”
100	Run the Red	Taking a risk	“Brake lights are for cowards”

Lo-fi / Indie / Bedroom (20)

#	Title	Angle	First line
101	Soft Focus	Blurry memories	“Edges blur when I think of you”
102	Thrifted Heart	Second-hand love	“Someone else wore it first”
103	Rainy Tuesday Kind of Love	Quiet romance	“Not a movie, just me and you”
104	Cassette Daydream	Nostalgia	“Rewinding what I never had”
105	Paper Planet	Small world, big feelings	“Folded up my whole universe”
106	Window Seat	Observing life	“Watching strangers live my dream”
107	Cold Coffee Conversations	Missed connection	“We talked until the cup went still”
108	Tiny Revolution	Everyday courage	“Got out of bed, that counts”
109	Low Battery Love	Running out of energy	“5 percent and still thinking of you”
110	Plant Parent	Healing and growth	“Learning how to keep things alive”
111	Blue Hour	Between day and night	“Neither here nor gone”

#	Title	Angle	First line
112	Cardigan Weather	Comfort	“Wrapped in someone else’s warmth”
113	Sticky Notes on the Fridge	Domestic intimacy	“Little words that hold the house”
114	Daydream Debt	Wasting time on you	“Owe the sky a thousand hours”
115	Bus Stop Poem	Everyday beauty	“Verses in the way you wait”
116	Maybe in March	Hopeful waiting	“Spring might make it right”
117	Headphones On	Escaping into music	“World’s quieter when I sing”
118	Salt and Honey	Bittersweet	“Tastes like both of us”
119	Dim Light Dancing	Slow dance at home	“Shoes off, lamp on”
120	Postcards from Myself	Self-reflection	“Wish you were here, me”

Bonus: 5 Hook-Writing Exercises

1. **The 10-Word Rule.** Write your hook as a text message in under 10 words.
2. **Say It Out Loud.** If you can’t say it in one breath, shorten it.
3. **Change the Verb.** Rewrite the hook with 3 different verbs. Pick the sharpest.
4. **Rhythm First.** Tap the rhythm of the hook on your desk before choosing words.
5. **The Taxi Test.** Explain the song to a stranger in one sentence. That sentence is probably your hook.

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